NOTE The `WebApplication` and `WebApplicationBuilder` classes were introduced in .NET 6. The initialization code in previous versions of ASP.NET Core was more verbose but gave you more control of your application's behavior. Configuration was typically split between two classes—`Program` and `Startup`—and used different configuration types—`IHostBuilder` and `IHost`, which have fewer defaults than `WebApplication`. In chapter 30 I describe some of these differences in more detail and show how to configure your application by using the generic `IHost` instead of `WebApplication`.

So far in this chapter, we've looked at the simplest ASP.NET core application you can build: a `Hello World` minimal API application. For the remainder of this chapter, we're going to build on this app to introduce some fundamental concepts of ASP.NET Core.

3.7 Adding functionality to your application

The application setup you've seen so far in Program.cs consists of only four lines of code but still shows the overall *structure* of a typical ASP.NET Core app entry point, which typically consists of six steps:

1. Create a `WebApplicationBuilder` instance.
2. Register the required services and configuration with the `WebApplicationBuilder`.
3. Call `Build()` on the builder instance to create a `WebApplication` instance.
4. Add middleware to the `WebApplication` to create a pipeline.
5. Map the endpoints in your application.